

Facebook!

Yahoo! adds integration with popular social networking site Facebook

Torrents. Legal?

Mininova has now done away with all illegal content on its servers

Google DNS

Google's new DNS service uses IP addresses 8.8.8.8 and 8.8.4.4

QnA

Try a different browser and also look at the applications using the most memory.

Windows time

I'm using Windows Vista Home Edition on an HP laptop. I am not able to update the system time using the Internet time update feature.

Prof. K.C. Raveendranathan

Try clicking on Start > Run (or [Windows] + [R]). Type cmd, press [Enter]. In the prompt, type ping time.nist.gov while connected online. If don't get a reply to your ping, the server might be down. Try later. If the server address doesn't resolve, there might be some kind of DNS problem on your ISP end.

Will Windows 7 run on an older PC?

I have a three-year old PC powered by an AMD Sempron 2600+, Gigabyte GA-K8VM800 motherboard, 1.5 GB RAM, 80 GB hard disk. Can you tell me if Windows 7 will run on this PC? If it won't, what can be done for it to run Windows 7. Please suggest a good graphics solution. 3d Studio Max and Maya are my favourite applications.

Said Fazil

Yes, Windows 7 will run just fine on your system. But you won't be able to run Windows Aero theme, although the OS itself will run perfectly fine. You should upgrade if you want to game or do intensive work on your system.

Simply upgrading your graphics won't improve the performance of 3dsMAX or Maya. It will also need an overall upgrade - CPU, motherboard, RAM and more.

The graphics card will only help while working in

the viewport and on high-density wireframes - it will be smoother than it is now with all kinds of mesh and turbo-smooth modifiers turned on. The rendering, however, is done only by the processor and memory. When you upgrade, don't look for a graphics card any slower than a GeForce 9600GT.

System goes blank during startup

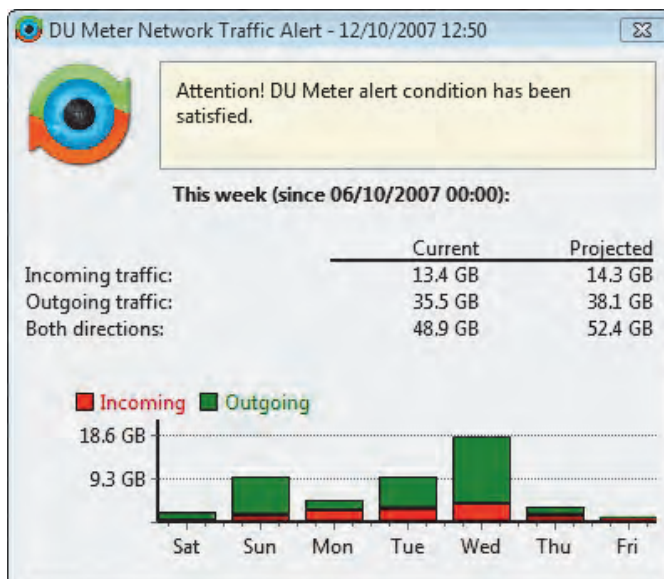
Recently, I have been having some problems booting my computer. It starts fine but goes blank when the boot screen shows up. It does not restart or show a BSOD. If I restart with the reset button, the same problem comes back. When I tried to install a fresh copy of Windows XP, it boots fine from the CD but goes blank just after loading all files. One of my friends suggested that it could be a problem with my RAM. Is it so? Should I go to my vendor with the memory or is it a fault with some other component? I was using Windows XP SP2.

Mayukh Biswas

Your friend maybe right. Try using Memtest86+ (www.memtest.org) to make sure that the memory doesn't have any errors or faults. The problem could be with some other component too - run a disk scan to check the drive for any bad sectors.

Internet bandwidth disappearing

I like your problem solving section. It's very helpful. I wanted to ask you one of my problems. My system configuration is an Intel Core 2 Duo, Intel GCCR945RY motherboard, 4 GB memory, 450 GB SATA hard drive. I use the internet connection but I've found that I have



Dumeter is a good bandwidth monitoring tool

extra data uploaded and downloaded. I have even disabled all the update options including ones for the Windows XP SP2 and all other installed software like codecs, anti-virus definition updates, security updates, etc. I have also disabled auto-updating of software. But still, I have a lot of extra data transfer. I calculate data usage using my download manager, browser and other using statistics. But when I check internet connection properties, it shows approximately 35 to 50 per cent extra. As I am using my mobile phone connection, it not only wastes my time but also makes a hole in my pocket. I need some help - is there any application that shows all the data being accessed by any software application or any type of update?

Vikram Paliwal

There is always some network traffic even with no browsing or downloading on. It definitely can't be 30 to 50 per cent more than your usage though. Try using a software called DUMeter (www.hageltech.com/dumeter/). The software also

tracks the total amount of data sent and received. Alarms can also be set. A free alternative to DUMeter is Netmeter (www.metal-machine.de/readerror/). It lacks many of the features of DUMeter though.

Blue screens and viruses woes

My PC configuration is as follows - Motherboard: MSI P45 Platinum, Processor: Intel Core2 Duo E8400 3.0GHZ (overclocked to 3.15 GHz), Memory: 2 x 1 GB Corsair XMS 2 800 MHz, Hard Disk: Seagate 7200.12 500 GB, Graphics Card: Sapphire Radeon 4670, OS: Windows XP SP2.

I had installed drivers for the graphics card, but when I install Catalyst, a blue screen shows up whenever Windows starts. I undid the process of installing Catalyst through system restore. Games such as Grid, NFS and Assassins Creed run perfectly fine, but I want Catalyst as well.

Also, CPU-Z And GPU-Z analyses my graphics card and shows the speed to be 200 MHz. Getting this card replaced is not an option for me.